

check for stability. If system is still unstable, then enable Fast Writes. Note that some graphics cards refuse to work with Fast Writes disabled.

Memory Resource Conflicts: This type of problem is rarely fixable. When you fix a new AGP card on an old AGP 1.0 slot, you might get memory resource conflicts. This would show up when you install the video card's display drivers. Try changing the memory addresses assigned through either the BIOS or Device Manager under Windows. If you are successful in getting the card to work, then you've been lucky! Typically, your only solution would be opt for a card that is compatible with your slot.

3.5 Troubleshooting Video Codecs

3.5.1 Problems

One of the common problems many people face is the inability to play some downloaded movie files or video CDs. There might be an error message stating that a particular codec is missing and needs to be installed before the file can play correctly. In many cases, the player will not give any kind of error message, leaving you mystified. Assuming that your CD and DVD drives are working without trouble, the culprit would be the lack of a supporting codec.

3.5.2 What are codecs?

"Codec" stands for "Compression-Decompression algorithm." In raw uncompressed form, multimedia files take up a huge amount of space. To minimise the space used, the multimedia video and/or audio files are encoded using a particular codec. When you want to listen to or view the file, a video/audio player decodes the information in the file using the specific compression-decompression algorithm. When a multimedia player (like Windows Media Player, Winamp, etc.) doesn't play a particular file, the problem is usually that the required codec is missing.